The capillary bed may be flooded with blood or may be completely bypassed depending on the body conditions in a particular organ.

Why there are no blood capillaries in the cornea of the eye and cartilage? How are these regions supplied with the required nutrients?

Suggest why arteries close to the heart have more elastic fibers in their walls than arteries further away from the heart?

Veins

Veins have thinner walls and a larger lumen and hence can be easily stretched. They carry deoxygenated blood except, the pulmonary vein. The blood pressure is low and the lumen has a wide wall which is collapsible. Tunica media is thinner in veins than in arteries. Unidirectional flow of blood in veins is due to the presence of semilunar valves that prevents backflow of blood. Blood samples are usually taken from the veins rather than artery because of low pressure in the veins.

7.2.1 Coronary blood vessels

Blood vessels that supply blood to the cardiac muscles with all nutrients and removes wastes are the coronary arteries and veins. Heart muscle is supplied by two arteries namely right and left coronary arteries. These arteries are the first branch of the aorta. Arteries usually surround the heart in the manner of a crown, hence called coronary artery (L. *Corona* - crown).

Right ventricle and posterior portion of left ventricle are supplied by the right coronary artery. Anterior and lateral part of the left ventricle is supplied by the left coronary arteries.

The Law of Laplace is used to understand the structure and function of blood vessels and the heart. Laplace law states that the tension in the walls of the blood vessel is proportional to the blood pressure and vessel radius. Blood vessels such as aorta that is subjected to high pressures have thicker walls than the arterioles that are subjected to low pressures.

7.3 Circulatory pathways



There are two types of circulatory systems, open and closed circulatory systems. **Open circulatory system has** haemolymph as the circulating fluid and is pumped by the heart, which flows through blood vessels into the sinuses. Sinuses are referred as **haemocoel**. Open circulatory system is seen in Arthropods and most Molluscs. In **closed circulatory system** blood is pumped by the heart and flows through blood vessels. Closed circulating system is seen in Annelids, Cephalopods and Vertebrates.

All vertebrates have muscular chambered heart. Fishes have two chambered heart. The heart in fishes consists of sinus venosus, an **atrium**, one **ventricle** and **bulbus arteriosus** or **conus arteriosus**. Single circulation is seen in fishes. Amphibians have two auricles and one ventricle and no inter ventricular septum whereas reptiles except crocodiles have two auricles and one ventricle and an incomplete inter ventricular septum. Thus mixing of oxygenated and deoxygenated

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